

Word Wall

Great Society

Gran Sociedad

say: grayt soh-SY-eh-tee

GS

President Lyndon B. Johnson's 1960s domestic program to end poverty and racial injustice and expand education, health care, and civil rights.

War on Poverty

Guerra contra la Pobreza

say: wor on POV-er-tee

WO

LBJ's set of Great Society programs — including Head Start and Job Corps — created in 1964 to reduce poverty in the United States.

Medicare and Medicaid

Medicare y Medicaid

say: MED-ih-kair and MED-ih-kaid

MA

Federal health-insurance programs created in 1965: Medicare for Americans 65 and older, Medicaid for low-income families.

Head Start

Head Start (Programa Preescolar)

say: hed START

HS

A 1965 Great Society program providing early childhood education, health, and nutrition services to low-income children.

Urban Renewal

Renovación Urbana

say: UR-bin ree-NOO-ul

UR

Federal programs that cleared and rebuilt city neighborhoods; often displaced poor and minority residents despite new housing and highways.

Voting Rights Act of 1965

Ley de Derecho al Voto de 1965

say: VOH-ting ryts akt

VR

A Great Society law that banned literacy tests and other barriers used to deny African Americans the right to vote.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Word Wall

Counterculture

say: KOWN-ter-kul-cher

Contracultura

CO

A 1960s youth movement that rejected mainstream values, embracing new music, dress, and views on peace, freedom, and social change.

Hippie Movement

say: HIP-ee MOOV-ment

Movimiento Hippie

HM

A counterculture group of the 1960s that promoted peace, love, communal living, and opposition to the Vietnam War.

Antiwar Movement

say: AN-tee-wor MOOV-ment

Movimiento contra la Guerra

AM

Widespread 1960s-70s protests, especially on college campuses, against U.S. involvement in the Vietnam War.

Generation Gap

say: jen-er-AY-shun gap

Brecha Generacional

GG

The sharp differences in values, politics, and culture between 1960s youth and their parents' generation.

Woodstock

say: WOOD-stok

Woodstock

WO

A 1969 music festival in New York that drew 400,000 people and became a symbol of the counterculture and antiwar spirit.

New Left

say: noo LEFT

Nueva Izquierda

NL

A 1960s political movement of young activists who pushed for civil rights, free speech, and an end to the Vietnam War.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Word Wall

Silent Majority

say: SY-lent muh-JOR-ih-tee

Mayoría Silenciosa

SM

President Nixon's term for the many Americans who quietly supported his policies but did not join loud public protests.

Nixon Visits China

say: NIK-sun VIZ-its CHY-nuh

Visita de Nixon a China

NV

Nixon's historic 1972 trip that reopened U.S. relations with Communist China after more than 20 years of hostility.

Revenue Sharing

say: REV-en-yoo SHAIR-ing

Distribución de Ingresos Federales

RS

A Nixon program returning federal tax money to state and local governments to spend on their own priorities.

Détente

say: day-TAHNT

Distensión

DT

Nixon's policy of easing Cold War tensions with the Soviet Union and China through diplomacy and treaties.

SALT I

say: salt WUN

SALT I (Tratado de Armas)

SI

The 1972 Strategic Arms Limitation Talks treaty that limited U.S. and Soviet nuclear missiles, a key result of détente.

Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)

say: en-vy-run-MEN-tul pro-TEK-shun

Agencia de Protección Ambiental

EP

A federal agency created under Nixon in 1970 to write and enforce laws protecting air, water, and land.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Word Wall

Watergate Scandal

Escándalo de Watergate

say: WAW-ter-gayt SKAN-dul

WS

A political scandal beginning with a 1972 break-in at Democratic headquarters that exposed abuses of power and forced Nixon to resign in 1974.

United States v. Nixon

Estados Unidos vs. Nixon

say: yoo-NY-ted stayts VER-sus NIK-sun

US

A 1974 Supreme Court ruling that the president is not above the law and must release the Watergate tapes.

Executive Privilege

Privilegio Ejecutivo

say: eg-ZEK-yoo-tiv PRIV-ul-ij

EP

A president's claimed right to keep some communications secret — rejected by the Court in the Watergate tapes case.

Ford's Pardon of Nixon

Indulto de Ford a Nixon

say: fordz PAR-dun

FS

President Gerald Ford's 1974 decision to pardon Nixon for any crimes, a choice that deepened public distrust of government.

Impeachment

Juicio Político

say: im-PEECH-ment

IM

The constitutional process for charging a president with serious wrongdoing; Nixon resigned before the House could impeach him.

Investigative Journalism

Periodismo de Investigación

say: in-VES-tih-gay-tiv JUR-nul-izm

IJ

In-depth reporting — like the Washington Post's Watergate coverage — that uncovers hidden wrongdoing by those in power.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Word Wall

Environmentalism

Ambientalismo

say: en-vy-run-MEN-tul-izm

EN

A movement that grew in the 1960s-70s to protect nature and public health from pollution and industrial harm.

Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)

Agencia de Protección Ambiental

say: en-vy-run-MEN-tul pro-TEK-shun

EP

The federal agency created in 1970 to set and enforce standards for clean air, water, and land.

Earth Day

Día de la Tierra

say: URTH day

ED

First held April 22, 1970, a nationwide event that raised public awareness and support for protecting the environment.

Love Canal

Love Canal

say: luv kuh-NAL

LC

A New York neighborhood built on buried toxic waste; its 1978 health crisis spurred federal cleanup laws like Superfund.

Three Mile Island

Three Mile Island

say: three myl EYE-lund

TM

A 1979 partial nuclear meltdown in Pennsylvania that heightened fears about nuclear power safety.

Clean Air Act

Ley de Aire Limpio

say: kleen AIR akt

CA

A landmark law (expanded 1970) authorizing the federal government to limit air pollution from industry and vehicles.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Word Wall

Stagflation

say: stag-FLAY-shun

Estanflación

ST

An unusual 1970s economy combining high inflation, high unemployment, and slow growth at the same time.

Camp David Accords

say: kamp DAY-vid uh-KORDZ

Acuerdos de Camp David

CD

A 1978 peace agreement between Egypt and Israel brokered by President Carter, a major diplomatic success.

Iran Hostage Crisis

say: ih-RAN HOS-tij KRY-sis

Crisis de los Rehenes en Irán

IH

The 1979-81 seizure of 52 Americans at the U.S. embassy in Iran for 444 days, which damaged Carter's presidency.

Energy Crisis

say: EN-er-jee KRY-sis

Crisis Energética

EC

1970s fuel shortages and soaring gas prices, worsened by an OPEC oil embargo, that strained the U.S. economy.

Panama Canal Treaty

say: PAN-uh-mah kuh-NAL

Tratado del Canal de Panamá

PC

Carter-era treaties (1977) agreeing to hand control of the Panama Canal over to Panama by the year 2000.

Human Rights Diplomacy

say: HYOO-mun ryts dih-PLOH-muh-see

Diplomacia de Derechos Humanos

HR

Carter's foreign policy of pressuring other nations to respect their citizens' basic rights.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Word Wall

Reaganomics

say: ray-gun-OM-iks

Reaganomía

RE

President Reagan's economic plan of tax cuts, reduced regulation, and lower domestic spending to spur growth (supply-side economics).

Supply-Side Economics

say: suh-PLY syd ee-kuh-NOM-iks

Economía de la Oferta

SS

The theory behind Reaganomics that cutting taxes on businesses and the wealthy encourages investment and benefits the whole economy.

Strategic Defense Initiative

say: struh-TEE-jik dee-FENS

Iniciativa de Defensa Estratégica

SD

Reagan's proposed 1983 space-based missile-defense system, nicknamed 'Star Wars,' to intercept Soviet nuclear attacks.

Iran-Contra Affair

say: ih-RAN KON-truh uh-FAIR

Caso Irán-Contra

IC

A 1980s scandal in which officials secretly sold arms to Iran and used the money to fund rebels in Nicaragua.

War on Drugs

say: wor on DRUGZ

Guerra contra las Drogas

WO

Expanded 1980s federal efforts to stop drug use and trafficking through tougher laws and enforcement.

AIDS Epidemic

say: aydz ep-ih-DEM-ik

Epidemia del SIDA

AE

The public-health crisis of the 1980s from a deadly new disease; the government's slow response drew wide criticism.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Word Wall

Persian Gulf War

say: PER-zhun gulf WOR

Guerra del Golfo Pérsico

PG

A 1991 U.S.-led coalition war that drove Iraqi forces out of Kuwait after Iraq's 1990 invasion.

Operation Desert Storm

say: op-er-AY-shun DEZ-ert storm

Operación Tormenta del Desierto

OD

The 1991 military campaign that quickly liberated Kuwait from Iraqi occupation.

Fall of the Berlin Wall

say: fawl of ber-LIN WAWL

Caída del Muro de Berlín

FO

The 1989 opening of the wall dividing East and West Berlin, a symbol of the Cold War's end.

Collapse of the Soviet Union

say: kuh-LAPS of SOH-vee-et

Colapso de la Unión Soviética

CO

The 1991 breakup of the USSR into independent nations, ending the Cold War.

Panama Invasion

say: PAN-uh-mah in-VAY-zhun

Invasión de Panamá

PI

The 1989 U.S. military action that removed Panamanian dictator Manuel Noriega from power.

Americans with Disabilities Act

say: uh-MER-ih-kunz with dis-uh-BIL-ih-teez

Ley de Estadounidenses con Discapacidades

AW

A 1990 law signed by President Bush banning discrimination against people with disabilities.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Word Wall

NAFTA

say: NAF-tuh

TLCAN

NA

The 1994 North American Free Trade Agreement removing most trade barriers among the U.S., Canada, and Mexico.

Balanced Budget

say: BAL-unst BUJ-it

Presupuesto Equilibrado

BB

A federal budget in which spending does not exceed revenue; achieved in the late 1990s under Clinton.

Contract with America

say: KON-trakt with uh-MER-ih-kuh

Contrato con América

CW

A 1994 Republican campaign plan led by Newt Gingrich promising smaller government and balanced budgets.

Welfare-to-Work Reform

say: WEL-fair to wurk ree-FORM

Reforma de Asistencia Social

WT

A 1996 Clinton-era law that limited welfare benefits and required recipients to find work.

Clinton Impeachment

say: KLIN-tun im-PEECH-ment

Juicio Político a Clinton

CI

The 1998 House impeachment of President Clinton for perjury and obstruction; the Senate acquitted him in 1999.

Dot-com Boom

say: dot-KOM boom

Auge de las Puntocom

DC

The late-1990s surge in internet-based businesses and stock values, which later crashed in 2000-01.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Word Wall

September 11, 2001 Attacks

Ataques del 11 de Septiembre

say: sep-TEM-ber ee-LEV-en uh-TAKS

SA

Coordinated al-Qaeda terrorist attacks that destroyed the World Trade Center and struck the Pentagon, killing nearly 3,000 people.

USA PATRIOT Act

Ley Patriota

say: yoo-es-AY PAY-tree-ut akt

UP

A 2001 law expanding government surveillance powers to prevent terrorism, criticized by some as a threat to civil liberties.

War in Afghanistan

Guerra en Afganistán

say: wor in af-GAN-ih-stan

WI

The U.S. war begun in 2001 to remove the Taliban and destroy al-Qaeda bases after the 9/11 attacks.

War on Terror

Guerra contra el Terrorismo

say: wor on TER-er

WO

The U.S. global campaign after 9/11 to defeat terrorist groups and the nations that harbored them.

Department of Homeland Security

Departamento de Seguridad Nacional

say: dee-PART-ment of HOHM-land

DO

A federal department created in 2002 to coordinate protection of the U.S. against terrorism and disasters.

Iraq War

Guerra de Irak

say: ih-RAK wor

IW

The 2003 U.S.-led invasion that toppled Saddam Hussein, launched on claims of weapons of mass destruction.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Word Wall

Sandra Day O'Connor

say: SAN-druh day oh-KON-er

Sandra Day O'Connor

SD

The first woman to serve on the U.S. Supreme Court, appointed in 1981.

Condoleezza Rice

say: kon-duh-LEE-zuh RYS

Condoleezza Rice

CR

The first African American woman U.S. Secretary of State (2005), a key foreign-policy leader.

Nancy Pelosi

say: NAN-see puh-LOH-see

Nancy Pelosi

NP

The first woman elected Speaker of the U.S. House of Representatives (2007).

Colin Powell

say: KOH-lin POW-ul

Colin Powell

CP

The first African American U.S. Secretary of State (2001) and Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff.

Hillary Clinton

say: HIL-uh-ree KLIN-tun

Hillary Clinton

HC

U.S. Senator, Secretary of State, and the first woman to win a major party's presidential nomination (2016).

Glass Ceiling

say: glas SEE-ling

Techo de Cristal

GC

An invisible barrier that has kept women and minorities from reaching the highest positions in business and government.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Word Wall

Internet Revolution

say: IN-ter-net rev-uh-LOO-shun

Revolución de Internet

IR

The rapid late-20th-century spread of the internet, transforming how people communicate, work, and access information.

Personal Computer

say: PER-sun-ul kum-PYOO-ter

Computadora Personal

PC

An affordable home computer that became common in the 1980s-90s, changing work, school, and daily life.

Smartphone

say: SMART-fohn

Teléfono Inteligente

SM

A mobile phone with internet and computer features, widespread after 2007, that put communication in every pocket.

World Wide Web

say: world wyd WEB

Red Informática Mundial

WW

A system of linked web pages, opened to the public in the 1990s, that made the internet easy to use.

Social Media

say: SOH-shul MEE-dee-uh

Redes Sociales

SM

Online platforms of the 2000s that let people share content and connect instantly around the world.

Digital Divide

say: DIJ-ih-tul dih-VYD

Brecha Digital

DD

The gap between those who have reliable access to computers and the internet and those who do not.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Word Wall

Affordable Care Act

Ley de Cuidado de Salud Asequible

say: uh-FOR-duh-bul KAIR akt

AC

President Obama's 2010 health-care law ('Obamacare') expanding insurance coverage to millions of Americans.

Great Recession

Gran Recesión

say: grayt ree-SESH-un

GR

The severe 2007-09 economic downturn — the worst since the Great Depression — marked by a housing and banking crisis.

American Recovery and Reinvestment Act

Ley de Recuperación y Reinversión

say: uh-MER-ih-kun ree-KUV-er-ee

AR

A 2009 stimulus law that used federal spending and tax cuts to fight the Great Recession.

First African American President

Primer Presidente Afroamericano

say: furst AF-rih-kun uh-MER-ih-kun

FA

Barack Obama, elected in 2008, whose presidency was a historic milestone in U.S. history.

Death of Osama bin Laden

Muerte de Osama bin Laden

say: deth of oh-SAH-muh bin LAH-den

DO

The 2011 U.S. special-forces raid that killed the al-Qaeda leader behind the 9/11 attacks.

Partisan Gridlock

Estancamiento Partidista

say: PAR-tih-zun GRID-lok

PG

Sharp division between Democrats and Republicans that blocked lawmaking during much of Obama's presidency.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.